

Dispatcher Character Cards — Role-Play Interviews

Day 3 · Activity 3 handout. One set of three cards per quad (print A5, or run digital). Each round, **only the "interviewee" reads the Hidden section of their card** — interviewers must surface those details with good questions. Interviewers work from the five validation questions, in order.

Facilitator: don't let interviewers see Hidden details in advance; that's the whole exercise.

Card 1 — Maria R.

Public surface (everyone may read)

- Lead Dispatcher, 90-technician HVAC shop
- 12 years dispatching
- Reputation: unflappable, keeps the branch running

Hidden — interviewee only

- Secretly keeps a **paper notebook** for truck stock because the app's inventory view is **3 clicks deep** and too slow when a tech is waiting on a roof.
 - Genuinely dreads **mid-day re-routes** — that's her worst hour.
 - Won't volunteer the notebook unless asked *how* she actually tracks stock. If the interviewer only asks about the app, she'll describe the app and never mention it.
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Card 2 — Trey W. (*the confidently-wrong card*)

Public surface (everyone may read)

- Dispatcher, 3 years; former field technician
- 60-technician shop

- Opinionated, talks fast, happy to generalize

Hidden — interviewee only

- Will **confidently state** that re-routes "happen all day, maybe 10 times a shift." **This is wrong** — it's really 2–3 times; he misremembers because the bad days stick.
 - If the interviewer asks a **memory-testing follow-up** ("walk me through the last time," "how often *this week?*"), you should slow down and correct yourself to the real number.
 - If they *don't* test your memory, stay confident and wrong.
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Card 3 — Susana O.

Public surface (everyone may read)

- Dispatcher, 18 years; the owner's daughter
- 160-technician shop
- Carries weight in the shop; the owner listens to her

Hidden — interviewee only

- The owner insists on **same-day reconcile** and you'll repeat that as "the requirement."
 - But the **real bottleneck is payroll's Wednesday deadline**, not dispatch — same-day is a proxy the owner invented. You don't realize this yourself until an interviewer asks *why* same-day matters and *what actually breaks* if it slips a day.
 - Reward good "why" questions by working this out loud.
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Interviewer's five questions (use in order)

1. Walk me through the last time you did X.
2. What was hardest about that?
3. What did you do to work around it?
4. How often does that happen?
5. If you could wave a wand, what would change?

Observer tally

Bias	Count
Leading question ("Wouldn't it be great if...")	
Confirmation (skipping disconfirming answers)	
Enthusiasm conflation ("they loved it!")	
Missed opportunity (hint dropped, no follow-up)	